

KURUKSHETRA: A LIFE · 30 OCTOBER 2026

Art brief annex: moments and watchers

Paintings for the game's new **moments**: short full-screen scenes, with their own music, that mark the turning points of a life: a friendship sealed in childhood, a divine weapon granted, a teacher's acceptance, a marriage. And two **portraits** for the people who watch whether you keep your vows. Until these arrive the game shows a portrait or emblem over an existing painting, so nothing waits on them.

Group	What	Images	Shape
A	Friendship moments: Arjuna, Bhima, Duryodhana, Karna, Charu	**10**	tall and wide
B	Milestone moments: the divine weapon granted, a teacher's acceptance, a marriage	**6**	tall and wide
C	Portraits of two watchers: Yudhishthira, Vidura	**2**	480×640
Total		**18**	

Moments that reuse paintings already in hand (no new art): taking a vow (scene_vow), getting your own company (scene_command_banner), the five named divine weapons later (the earning stages in the weapons and magic brief).

RULES

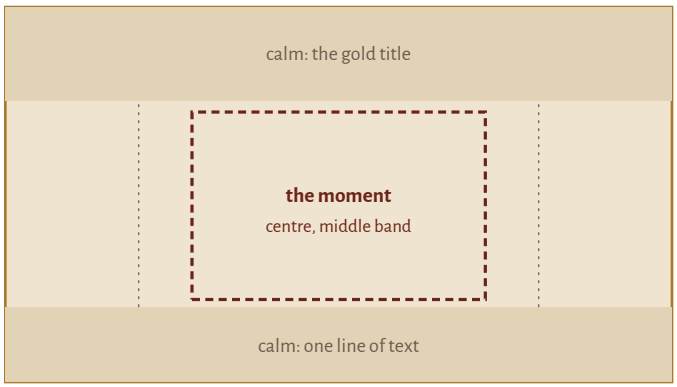
Rules for this annex

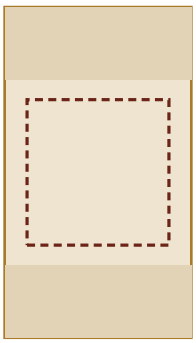
Everything in the main brief applies: the game's warm, painterly early-historic India; no painted text; timber, brick and stone (no domes, tall temple spires, castle battlements or Greek columns); no crescent emblems; no blood; made or licensed for this project, AI use noted. Specific to these pictures:

- **A moment, not a scene.** Each painting is the single image a player will remember: warm, close, a little larger than life. One clear subject in the centre, quiet edges.
- **No faces of canon characters in the moments.** The children and adults are small, half-turned or seen from behind; hands and gestures carry the feeling. The game's leather puppets step in over the painting from the left and right edges, so keep those edges free of figures.
- **Children are about ten** in the friendship moments, dressed simply; the princes a little finer (a fillet, an armlet), never crowns.
- **Calm bands:** the top quarter carries a gold title and the bottom fifth one line of text; keep both quiet (sky, wall, ground, shadow).
- **The divine weapon is never shown in use** and no god is shown: light and the weapon laid down are enough.
- **Portraits** need advisory review before public use, like the other canon portraits.

Layout

Wide 2560×1440: puppets step in from the dotted lines





Tall 1080×1920

Kind	Size	Notes
Moment, tall	1080×1920 (9:16)	Phones. Subject in the middle 44% of the height; quiet top quarter and bottom fifth.
Moment, wide	2560×1440 (16:9)	Laptops and desktops. Subject in the centre 44% of the width; the outer fifths free for the puppets.
Portrait	480×640 (3:4)	Head and shoulders, matching p_drona and p_kripa: plain warm background, lit from one side.

GROUP A · 10 IMAGES

Friendship moments

Five paintings, each tall and wide, one for each friend a child can win in Act I.



moment_friend_arjuna_tall · moment_friend_arjuna

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when you win Arjuna's friendship: the lamp test at night in the palace garden.

Paint: Night in the palace garden: a single clay lamp on a low wall, its flame steady; an arrow stands in the earth beside it, just through the lamp's light. Two boys of about ten sit side by side on the wall's edge, seen from behind, one holding a small bow across his knees, shoulders touching. Fireflies, deep blue night, warm lamplight on the boys' backs.

Match: stage_palace_garden_night



moment_friend_bhima_tall · moment_friend_bhima

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when you win Bhima's friendship: the wrestling bout in the river shallows.

Paint: Late afternoon at the river shallows: two boys, soaked, one much bigger, sitting in the knee-deep water laughing, the big one's arm thrown round the other's shoulders; splashes still in the air, sun low and golden on the water. Seen half from behind; faces turned away or in shadow.

Match: stage_river_shallows



moment_friend_duryodhana_tall · moment_friend_duryodhana

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when you win Duryodhana's friendship: standing your ground in the lotus garden.

Paint: The lotus garden at dusk: two boys standing at the edge of a pond of pink lotuses, the finer-dressed one with his hand on the other's shoulder, both looking out over the water toward the palace roofs (timber and tile, no domes). Long shadows, lamps being lit along the paths. Seen from behind.

Match: stage_lotus_garden



moment_friend_karna_tall · moment_friend_karna

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when you win Karna's friendship: calming the maddened horse together.

Paint: The stable yard at sunset: a tall chestnut horse, calm now, its head lowered between two boys who each lay a hand on its neck; straw on the ground, a dropped rope, dust settling in the low light. The boys small beside the horse, seen from behind and the side. Warm, quiet, after the storm.

Match: stage_stable_yard



moment_friend_charu_tall · moment_friend_charu

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when you choose Charu, the blacksmith's child, as your friend.

Paint: The village forge at evening: two children (Charu may be a boy or a girl; keep it open, simple clothes, hair tied back) sharing one hammer handle over the anvil, a shower of orange sparks between them, the fire glowing behind. Seen from the side and behind; soot and warmth.

Match: stage_smithy

GROUP B · 6 IMAGES

Milestone moments

Three paintings, each tall and wide, for the divine weapon and two milestones of a life.



moment_astra_tall · moment_astra

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when a divine weapon (astra) is granted, whether by a teacher or through penance.

Paint: A forest clearing at night: a single shaft of pale gold light falls from a break in the canopy onto a bow and one arrow laid on a cloth on the ground; the arrow's head glows faintly; motes of light drift in the beam; the surrounding trees deep blue-green. No figure, no god, no weapon in use. Awe and stillness.

Match: stage_forest_clearing_night



moment_teacher_tall · moment_teacher

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown when a teacher accepts you as a student (Drona, Kripa, Balarama, Mauni or Vidura; one painting serves all).

Paint: A teacher's courtyard at dawn: a young student kneels to touch the feet of a seated teacher (an older man in plain white, seen from behind or only to the shoulders), mist on the ground, a bow and a few weapons on a rack under a timber veranda, the first light behind. Both figures small in the frame; no face shown.

Match: scene_teacher_wide



moment_marriage_tall · moment_marriage

Moment · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Shown at your marriage (whoever you marry; one painting serves all).

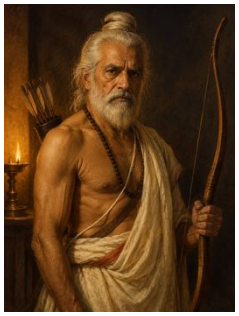
Paint: A wedding by lamplight: close on two pairs of hands joined over a small sacred fire in a brick altar, a garland of marigolds and jasmine around both wrists, rice grains and petals scattered, brass lamps and a pot of water; red and gold cloth. Faces out of frame. Warm and intimate.

Match: scene_swayamvara_wide

GROUP C · 2 IMAGES

Portraits of two watchers

Two canon portraits for the speaker cards and the bonds panel.



p_yudhishthira

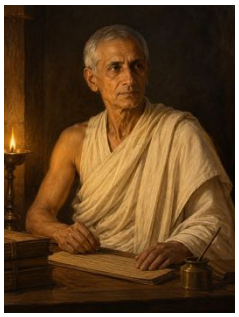
Portrait · 480×640

Used for: Speaker card and bonds panel for Yudhishthira, who watches the vow never to lie (he forgives a broken vow last of all).

Paint: Yudhishthira, eldest of the Pandavas: about forty, calm and grave, a short dark beard, a simple gold crown band (not a tall crown), white and pale gold garments, a string of rudraksha; the steady, slightly sad eyes of a man who will not lie. Warm plain background.

Note: Advisory review. Match the framing and light of p_drona and p_kripa.

Match: p_drona



p_vidura

Portrait · 480×640

Used for: Speaker card and bonds panel for Vidura, the Kuru court's wise minister, who also watches the vow never to lie.

Paint: Vidura: about fifty-five, lean, thoughtful, a neat grey beard, hair tied in a simple knot, plain off-white garments with a dark shawl, no crown; a scribe's stylus tucked at the waist; a knowing, kind expression. Warm plain background.

Note: Advisory review. He has a teacher card already (teacher_vidura); keep the face consistent with it.

Match: p_kripa

ALSO

What needs no new paintings

- **Taking a vow** uses **scene_vow** (the river ghat with lamps); **getting your own company** uses **scene_command_banner** (delivered 30 October).
- **The five named divine weapons** use the earning stages already ordered in the weapons and magic brief, with their emblems.
- **The practice ground** uses the training ground painting; the straw dummy, partners and teacher are drawn by the game.
- **A friendship's end** (after a broken vow) uses the friend's portrait; **penance** uses the ashram painting.

Delivery and checklist

- Name every file exactly as listed (moments as _tall.jpg and .jpg; portraits as .jpg).
- One zip; partial batches are fine, group A first. Upload to art_review/ in the GitHub repo, or attach in the chat.
- Render at native size wherever your tool allows; send the native render alongside any enlargement. Note which pieces are AI-generated and which tool made them.

☐	Moments: tall 1080×1920 (under 600 KB) and wide 2560×1440 (under 1 MB); subject in the centre; quiet top quarter and bottom fifth; outer edges free for the puppets
☐	No canon faces in the moments; children about ten; no crowns on the princes
☐	No god shown and no weapon in use in the astra moment
☐	Portraits 480×640, framed and lit like p_drona and p_kripa
☐	No text, signatures or watermarks; no blood; no domes, tall spires, battlements, Greek columns or crescent emblems
☐	Made or licensed for this project; AI use noted; portraits flagged for advisory review